



Confused, By the Numbers

A Swipe-Card Audit of Wayfinding Time Before and After a Corridor's Directional Signage Became a Mural

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The problem

Facilities repainted the Link corridor's directional arrows into a commissioned mural in week 8 and, after a spike in wayfinding complaints, launched a weekly confusion index from complaint volume alone. Does the index track how long people actually take to find the room, or only how loudly they say so?

Research questions

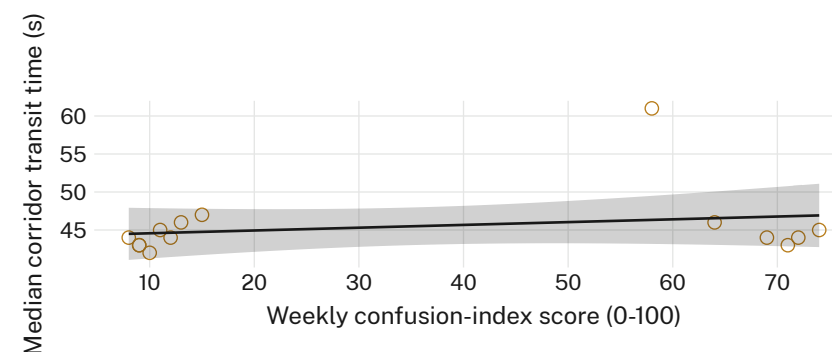
- Do badge-reader transit times through the corridor change after the signage-to-mural conversion?
- Does the confusion index track measured transit time or only complaint volume?
- How long does any transit-time effect of the repaint actually persist?

Study design

- n = 14 weeks · badge-reader transit logs · Link Building east-west corridor (8 weeks pre-repaint, 6 post)
- Confusion index: Facilities' published weekly score, 0–100, derived from Service Desk complaint counts
- Linear model of transit time against index score; repaint week held out as a covariate

Findings

Median transit time rose from 44s to 61s in the week of the repaint before recovering to baseline within two weeks. The confusion index rose in step but has not come back down.



Weekly confusion-index score against median transit time, 14 weeks to 22 June 2026; the two track weakly ($r = 0.23$, $n = 14$, $p = 0.42$).

Implications

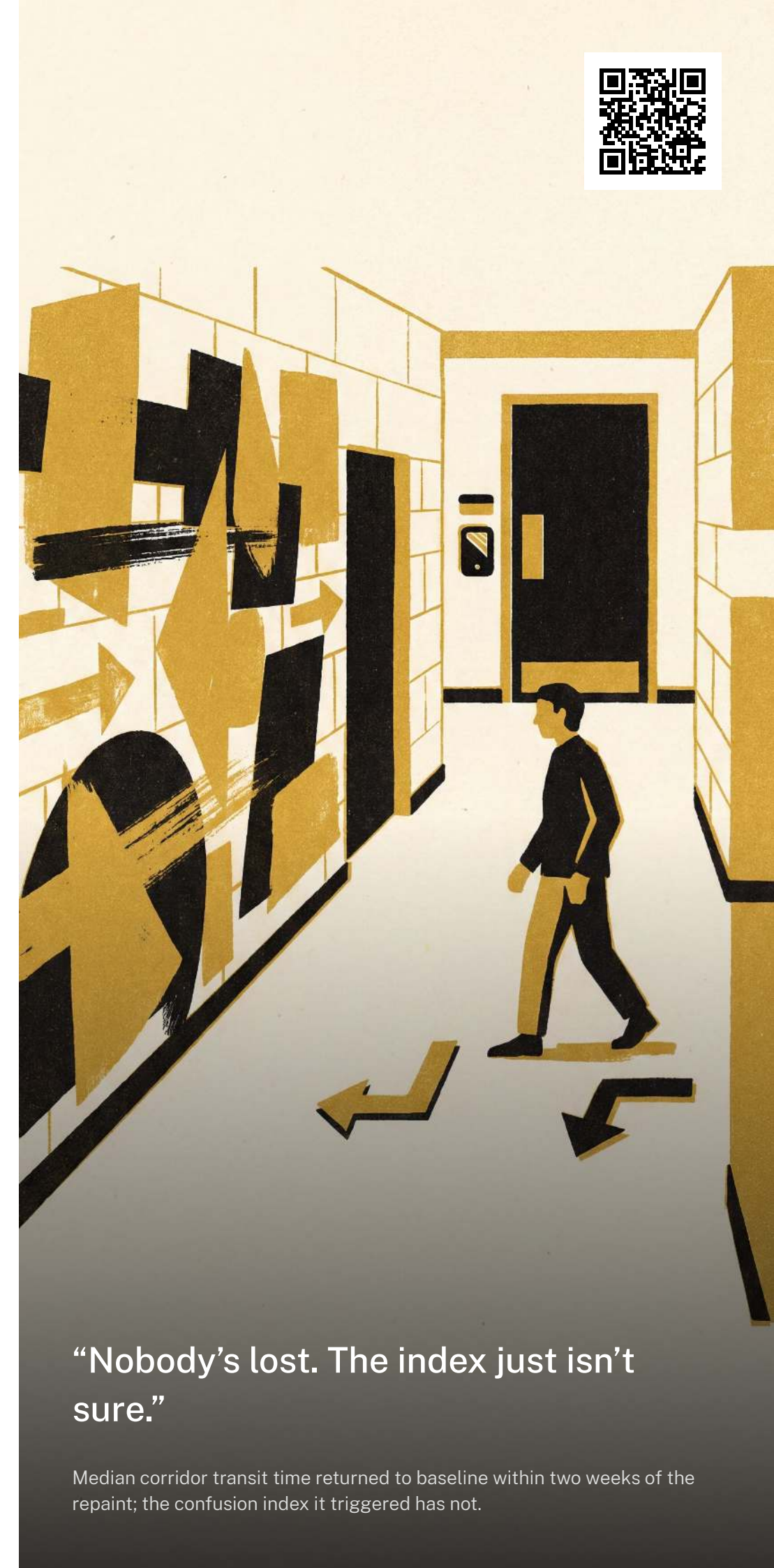
People found the door again days before Facilities did. Complaint volume, not transit time, is what the index measures, and nothing in its design forces a reset once volume subsides. Next: revalidate before the index is extended to other corridors.

Selected references

1. Iftikhar, H., & Luximon, Y. (2022). The syntheses of static and mobile wayfinding information. *Facilities*, 40(7/8), 452–474. doi:10.1108/F-06-2021-0052
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De-identified badge-reader timestamps only; no individual routes retained. Confusion index scores sourced from Facilities' published weekly dashboard.

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“Nobody’s lost. The index just isn’t sure.”

Median corridor transit time returned to baseline within two weeks of the repaint; the confusion index it triggered has not.